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30-DAY SOURCING PLAN
MICHIGAN / U-M NETWORK

A co-investment fund is only as good as its access to the leads writing the rounds. Four entry points for the Michigan corridor, chosen so they **do not overlap** — aggregator, seed lead, sector lead, alumni capital — plus the cadence I would run against them. **Coverage before volume:** four slots chosen so no two see the same deal, which is the identical structure I would run on any region, sector, or thesis I was handed.

4

NON-OVERLAPPING ENTRY POINTS

30 days

TO FIRST WARM INTRO

3rd

MI RANK, IN-STATE DEAL SHARE

\$60M

NEW STATE FUND-OF-FUNDS

THE FOUR CALLS

Each opens a different door; each ask offers work, because cold asks do not compound

U-M Innovation Partnerships

+ Zell Lurie Institute / Desai Accelerator

Ann Arbor, MI

WARMEST

SLOT: DEAL-FLOW AGGREGATOR

Why them. The single densest source of U-M-affiliated companies: it invested in **28 Michigan companies in 2025** and sits on top of university IP, spinouts, and the student venture pipeline. My WVF and Zell Lurie affiliation is a direct, credible line in.

The ask. A standing monthly review of spinouts raising priced Seed/A rounds with an outside lead already committed, which is exactly the shape a co-investment fund can act on.

RPM Ventures

Seed and early-stage, ~100 investments

Ann Arbor, MI

HIGH PRIORITY

SLOT: SEED LEAD TO CO-INVEST BEHIND

Why them. Founded 2000, seed and early-stage across fintech, insurtech, and mobility, with 20+ exits. They lead the rounds a co-investment vehicle wants to sit inside, and they are local enough to see U-M deals first.

The ask. Where they are leading in the next two quarters, and whether they want a fast, low-friction co-investor who can clear diligence inside their timeline rather than slowing the round.

Arboretum Ventures

Healthcare, ~\$700M–\$1B under management

Ann Arbor, MI

SECTOR DEPTH

SLOT: SECTOR LEAD, HEALTH

Why them. Twenty-plus years in healthcare, 110+ companies backed, with an SI-BONE IPO on the record. Michigan health-tech deal flow largely routes through them, and it pairs with the clinical-workflow diligence I ran at WVF.

The ask. Their view on where U-M clinical research is producing fundable companies, and which of those rounds have room for a co-investor alongside them.

Michigan Angel Fund + Wolverine Angels

Ann Arbor SPARK / U-M alumni angels

Ann Arbor, MI

NETWORK PLAY

SLOT: ALUMNI CAPITAL POOL

Why them. The closest structural analogue to an alumni fund: U-M alumni, professors, and families investing in early Michigan companies, with regular pitch events. They see deals pre-institutional and they already believe the alumni thesis.

The ask. Standing invitations to pitch nights, plus a co-diligence relationship where I take the commercial workstream and they surface the founder relationships.

THE CADENCE

Every week earns the next one; week 4 is the only week that counts

WK 1

Warm the alumni line

Innovation Partnerships and Zell Lurie first. Reintroduce through WVF, ask for the spinout pipeline, not a favor.

WK 2

Meet the leads

RPM and Arboretum. Arrive with a point of view on two of their portfolio companies, not a request for deal flow.

WK 3

Work the angel layer

Michigan Angel Fund and Wolverine Angels pitch night. Volunteer for the commercial diligence nobody wants to run.

WK 4

Convert to a memo

Take the strongest company through full diligence and put a written recommendation in front of the IC. A plan that ends at coffee is a networking plan.